🥕 Fruits & Vegetables: Reading

Culinary 1 · Unit 5 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with Fruits & Vegetables Unit + Fruits & Vegetables (PowerPoints and note sheets)

Name: _____

Fruits and Vegetables

In cooking and science, a fruit is the part of the plant that holds the seeds. A vegetable is any other part of the plant we eat: roots, stems, leaves, flowers, bulbs or tubers. That is why a tomato is really a fruit.

Fruits are sorted into groups. Pomes have a core, like apples and pears. Drupes have one big pit, like peaches and cherries. Berries are small and juicy, like strawberries. Melons are big with lots of water, like watermelon. Citrus fruits are juicy and sour, like oranges and lemons. Tropical fruits grow where it is hot, like bananas and pineapples.

Vegetables are sorted by the part we eat: a carrot is a root, celery is a stem, lettuce is a leaf, broccoli is a flower, an onion is a bulb and a potato is a tuber.

Fruits and vegetables give us vitamins and fiber. Vitamin C helps heal cuts. Vitamin A keeps eyes healthy. Food that is in season is cheaper and tastes best.

In the stir-fry lab, cut vegetables the same size so they cook evenly, cook in a hot pan or wok with a little oil, and stir often. Vegetables should be tender-crisp: bright in color and still a little crunchy.

Check your reading

1. What is the difference between a fruit and a vegetable?

2. Name the fruit group for an apple and for a peach.

3. What does tender-crisp mean?